and foreign policy. On the one hand, Mao and the radicals seemed to favour confrontation coming out of a class-struggle view of politics; on the other hand, Liu Shaoqi and Deng Xiaoping seemed to favour pragmatic accommodation in the interest of economic development. Mao himself wavered. As Garver notes, in early 1959, Mao was confrontational over agricultural policy. In foreign policy, he criticized senior party official and former diplomat Wang Jiaxing's *sanhe yishao* policy of 1961 which had proposed reducing conflict with the big powers and India, as also curtailing aid to revolutionary movements abroad.[51] However, at a party conference in January 1962 Mao supported a more accommodative stance. By the summer of 1962, he had apparently changed his mind again, emphasizing class struggle in agricultural policy and in foreign policy. Eric Hyer's study of China's policies towards its neighbours at this time argues, 'The causes of this change of views [in summer 1962] were rooted in his [Mao's] fears that the success of the pragmatic economic recovery policies, which his fellow leaders Liu Shaoqi and Deng Xiaoping had implemented to alleviate the economic problems that Mao's own brainchild . . . had caused, threatened his political standing within the party and the country.'[52]

Finally, why in the end were India and China so far apart? The answer is that the two leaderships had deep-rooted differences in political values. India under Nehru took a conservative position, arguing that borders inherited from imperial times must be sacrosanct. Legally and from the point of view of international stability, that was vital. Otherwise, the world would be full of newly independent countries all seeking to renegotiate colonial boundaries. China under Mao took a revisionist position, arguing instead that imperially defined borders were illegitimate: they had been forced on China as well as India. Countries could and should come to agreements on boundaries once they had emancipated themselves from the bonds of colonial era treaties and agreements. Perhaps these quite different positions were merely postures lacking substance, when the real issues were strategic gain, honour, and prestige. A less cynical view would be that both perspectives were understandable, in two countries that had just emerged from imperial domination via different historical struggles. Politically,